Agency Grader

Free digital presence audit for insurance agencies → demo bookings for PolicyLift

March 2026 | Strategy Approved | Phase 1 Built

What is it?

An agency owner types their business name, and in 30 seconds gets a scored audit of their online presence. No signup, no email gate. The full report is free. The CTA is **"Book a Demo."**

> **The model:** Owner.com's Restaurant Grader, HubSpot's Website Grader. Our twist — Google Places identifies the agency automatically. Every gap maps to a PolicyLift product. The conversion event is a demo booking, not an email capture.

The Funnel = The Report

The grader is organized around the PolicyLift funnel. The funnel IS the report structure — no separate category names competing for attention.

STAGE 1

Discovery

"Can they find you?"

10 checks · 50 points

STAGE 2

Trust

"Do they trust you?"

5 checks · 25 points

STAGE 3

Capture & Qualify

"Can they reach you and start the process?"

4 checks · 25 points

STAGE 4 — CTA

Intake → Quote → Bind → Service

"PolicyLift automates the rest with AI."

Not scored — this is the hook

What We Score — 19 Checks

Every check is something most agencies will **fail**. No filler.

Stage 1: Discovery — 50 pts

1	Ranks for "[city] insurance" keywords	SEMrush
2	Organic keyword count ≥ 50	SEMrush
3	Domain Authority ≥ 20	SEMrush
4	Page load under 3 seconds	Lighthouse
5	Mobile-responsive site	Lighthouse
6	Title/meta includes city + "insurance"	Firecrawl
7	Non-brand traffic > 20%	SEMrush
8	Has dedicated local/coverage pages	Firecrawl

9	Backlink health (toxic vs legit ratio)	SEMrush
10	Monthly organic traffic ≥ 200	SEMrush

> **Why it's heavy:** SEO problems produce the most concrete, personalized data. "You rank for 299 keywords but only 3 visitors a month are shopping for insurance" is a gut punch. This stage also upsells into our existing full SEO audit report.

Stage 2: Trust — 25 pts

1	Google rating ≥ 4.5	Google Places
2	50+ Google reviews	Google Places
3	Review within last 30 days	Google Places
4	Owner responds to reviews	Google Places
5	Reviews showcased on website	Firecrawl

Stage 3: Capture & Qualify — 25 pts

1	After-hours availability (voice AI, chat, or evening/weekend hours)	Places + Firecrawl
2	AI-powered chat (not just a basic live chat widget)	Firecrawl
3	Insurance-specific forms (coverage type, vehicle, property, etc.)	Firecrawl
4	Self-service booking/calendar	Firecrawl

User Flow

Landing page (Type agency name) → 30s scan animation (Their data revealed live) → Results page (Score + funnel + checks) →

Book a Demo
The conversion event

> **The emotional hook:** During the scan, the agency owner watches their own data appear in real-time — their Google rating, their website screenshot, their keyword rankings. They're seeing themselves analyzed. That's what keeps them watching for 30 seconds.

Tech Stack

Component	Technology
Frontend + API	Next.js (App Router) on Vercel
Business lookup	Google Places API
SEO intelligence	SEMrush API
Website analysis	Firecrawl (single crawl per domain)
Page speed	Lighthouse / PageSpeed Insights API
Lead tracking	HubSpot API
AI summary	Claude API (Haiku)
Cache	Vercel KV (SEMrush 7-day, rest 24hr)

Build Status

BUILT **Phase 1:** Next.js scaffold, Google Places autocomplete, SSE scan route, Trust scoring, funnel UI, design tokens

NEXT **Phase 2:** Lighthouse (page speed, mobile), full scoring engine with all 19 checks, results page polish

NEXT **Phase 3:** SEMrush + Firecrawl integration, AI chat detection, form analysis, insurance keyword matching

NEXT **Phase 4:** Scan animation choreography, AI verdict, HubSpot lead creation, caching, rate limiting

NEXT **Phase 5:** Deploy to grader.policylift.ai, test with 20 real agencies, accuracy fixes, demo booking CTA

Design Team — What We Need

1. **Funnel visualization** — Our funnel graphic adapted to show scores on top 3 stages + CTA on stage 4. Must work mobile (stacked) and desktop.
2. **Scanning animation** — 30-second choreographed reveal showing the agency's own data. Each stage has a unique icon and data card.
3. **Results page** — Score donut + letter grade above fold, funnel walkthrough below, CTA at bottom. Pass/fail/unverified states per check.
4. **Error states** — No results, scan timeout, no website detected, partial results. Warm and actionable, not dead ends.
5. **Mobile responsive** — Full-width input, stacked funnel, sticky "Book a Demo" at bottom after score is shown.

Decisions Already Made

✓ **No email gate.** Google Places gives us the lead. CTA is demo booking.

- ✓ **Funnel is the report.** No separate category names competing with funnel stages.
- ✓ **Score out of 100.** Weighted 50/25/25 across 3 scored stages.
- ✓ **"Unable to verify" ≠ failure.** Honest about detection limits. Neutral icon, asterisk on score.
- ✓ **Discovery is the SEO teaser.** Full SEO audit report is the upsell from the demo.
- ✓ **No filler checks.** Every check must be something most agencies fail.
- ✓ **Honest scoring — no gated points.** If an agency earns 100/100, they get it. No artificial ceiling that forces a sale. Most agencies will fail plenty of checks on their own.
- ✓ **CTA earns the meeting, doesn't extort it.** The grader builds trust by being genuinely useful. The CTA asks the question they can't answer: "You scored 62 on the top of your funnel. But what happens after someone fills out that form at 11pm?" Two value props — fix what's broken (grader) + automate what you can't (PolicyLift).